

Schema Support for Families



Why this happens: Watching water fall through small holes creates simple cause and effect wonder that naturally slows down quick body energy without any pressure to make a finished product.

Try This:

Take a plastic kitchen colander outdoors into the garden. Ask your child to hold the colander over a shallow water tub while you or a sibling gently pour water inside using a plastic measuring cup to create a soft rain shower together.

How did watching the water fall help you both pause and enjoy the quiet moment together?

Rung 1 of 10
Colander Rain Cloud

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Why this happens: Circular whisking movements satisfy a rotational play urge while building hand strength and shared laughter with no right or wrong way to play.

Try This:

Place a wide plastic mixing bowl with warm water and a splash of gentle soap on an outdoor picnic mat. Hold a whisk with your child or let an older sibling and younger child take turns spinning the whisk to make fluffy bubble foam.

What did you notice about your child body energy as the bubble foam grew bigger?

Rung 2 of 10
Whisking Bubble Foam

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Why this happens: Tapping a shared rhythm releases built up body energy in a safe way while helping family members tune into each other nervous system.

Try This:

Bring a few overturned plastic bowls and wooden kitchen spoons out to the garden lawn. Sit together on the grass and tap a gentle slow drumbeat together, matching each other physical speed instead of rushing.

How did matching a slow sound beat help bring a sense of calm to your yard?

Rung 3 of 10

Wooden Spoon Rhythm

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Why this happens: Squeezing kitchen tongs works deep hand muscles to release daily tension, while placing items into tin cups gives a comforting feeling of order and care.

Try This:

Scatter smooth garden stones, large leaves, or pinecones on a garden deck. Give your child plastic kitchen tongs while an older sibling or parent holds a metal muffin tin to receive each treasure safely.

How did working as a team to collect nature items feel for your family unit?

Rung 4 of 10
Tongs Treasure Pick

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Why this happens: Connecting two kitchen items requires two people to coordinate their hands together, turning simple water pouring into a gentle moment of connection.

Try This:

Sit on the garden grass with a plastic jug and a wide kitchen funnel. Ask an older child or parent to hold the funnel over a bowl while a younger child uses a plastic measuring cup to pour water inside slowly.

What soft words or gentle smiles passed between you while filling the bowl?

Rung 5 of 10
Funnel Water Pass

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Why this happens: Filling small cups satisfies an enclosing play urge, giving children a sense of calm control over their world with zero expectation of a right or wrong result.

Try This:

Take a metal muffin tin out to the garden soil. Let your child scoop water, flower petals, and soft dirt into the cups with silicone soup ladles while you sit nearby and join in without steering the play outcome.

How did letting go of the play outcome help you feel fully present with your child?

Rung 6 of 10

Muffin Tin Nature Soup

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Why this happens: Pushing down on a rolling pin provides deep heavy muscle feedback that grounds restless bodies and encourages slow cooperative movement.

Try This:

Place damp garden soil or play dough on a low outdoor table. Hold a wooden rolling pin with your child or let two siblings place their hands side by side on the handles to roll it flat together.

What did you feel in your own hands and shoulders while rolling the pin together?

Rung 7 of 10
Rolling Pin Earth Smooth

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Why this happens: Scooping floating items exercises hand coordination and cause and effect awareness, while handing items to a family member builds sweet emotional warmth.

Try This:

Float green leaves or plastic lids in a shallow garden water tray. Let a toddler or young child scoop them up with a slotted kitchen spoon and pass them directly into a plastic bowl held by a parent or older sibling.

How did your child express pride when passing each rescued item to you?

Rung 8 of 10
Slotted Spoon Rescue

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Why this happens: Feeling temperature shifts and watching ice change state creates quiet sensory fascination that captures developing minds without any pressure to perform.

Try This:

Place ice cubes in a wide plastic dish outdoors on a warm deck. Use silicone spatulas to slide the ice back and forth together, or pour small drops of warm water over the ice using a measuring spoon to watch it shrink.

How did exploring the cool ice bring a quiet moment of focus to your day?

Rung 9 of 10

Ice Cube Melt Spark

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Why this happens: Catching and moving sunlight reflections satisfies a visual tracking urge, creating a simple shared moment of awe for all ages without needing special toys.

Try This:

Sit on a garden picnic blanket with shiny metal pot lids. Tilt the lids together toward the morning sun to catch soft light reflections on the grass, moving them slowly to watch the light dance together.

What quiet wonder did you and your child share while watching the light move across the grass?

Rung 10 of 10
Pot Lid Sun Reflector